

**"THE ROSWELL INCIDENT; THE RUSH TOWARD
FULL ACCOUNTING"**

\$5.00


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FOREWORD

I have prepared this paper in the public interest and in the firm belief that the truth is often far stranger than fiction. The fact I'm even attempting to approach this subject demonstrates confidence that readers will at least allow a slight suspension of disbelief in order to fully review and consider the implications of the material presented.

As with all matters not involving direct physical evidence, interested parties are urged to consider other viewpoints on the matter; however that is not to say I'm including any "disclaimer" in the paper. In view of the many similar accounts along with first and second hand witness statements for the Roswell incident, many of which are now surfacing some forty eight years after the fact, one would have to accept a certain level of high intellectual tolerance in order to still maintain that absolutely nothing terribly out of the ordinary occurred in the Corona Desert area of New Mexico all those years ago.

Conversely, it is the continuing contention of many people that in early July 1947 a spectacular event with historic implications for mankind took place in New Mexico some seventy five miles northwest of the city of Roswell. Regrettably for many of us, there has apparently existed a most concerted effort on the part of the US Military to make this event completely disappear from history by means of a disinformation program and outright denial, both for reasons known only to the perpetrators and yet to be made public.

The antidote to such practices is a discerning citizenry, a passionate search for truth, and the occasional and reputable source who often takes great risks in revealing the facts as they know them. Time may be running out on the lives of those citizens who participated, either by order or by accident, in some aspect of the Roswell scenario; yet many of those same people now speak as if their lifelong fear of ridicule, possible imprisonment, and treatment as unpatriotic criminals no longer has relevance. A number of them seem to treat their silence as having lived a lie, one they say they no longer can accept.

What happened to some of those witnesses and their relatives represents one reason behind my decision to research the subject and prepare the paper in its behalf. The intense pressure to remain silent about the incident, with the threat of jail, fines and loss of benefits for the military personnel involved, is an astonishing chapter in our nation's history, one capable of being rectified if those in the know were willing to allow full access to the real Roswell story.

Robert J. VanDerClock

THE ROSWELL INCIDENT AND ITS AFTERMATH

On an evening in early July, 1947, impoverished sheep rancher W. W. "Mac" Brazel and other southwestern New Mexico residents heard a loud, explosion like sound in the sky. Occurring during a very heavy thunderstorm, it was assumed to be a weather related thunderclap although distinctly louder than the existing weather pattern.

The next morning, however, Brazel came upon the apparent scattered remains of what he thought may have been a downed rocket or a plane, spread over thousands of feet in the Corona desert area.¹ The rancher's sheep refused to move in the general direction of the debris, and he figured it initially to be a stray craft launched or piloted from nearby Roswell Army Air Base (RAAB). Soon after, Brazel dutifully contacted Roswell Army Air base via a phone call from the local Chavez County Sheriff's Office, certain that the Military would want to know of the wreckage, and eager for a cleanup of "the mess."

Major Jesse Marcel, The Roswell Base Intelligence Officer was first notified on the matter. Marcel represented the legendary 509th Bombardment Group that had dropped history's first atomic bombs on Japan, effectively ending World War II. After a night's travel over mainly dirt and desert "roads", Marcel, Counterintelligence Officer Sheridan Cavitt and the rancher arrived at the scene the next morning. Marcel almost immediately realized the wreckage wasn't normally attributed to anything from his Air Base. Some of the aluminum like fragments possessed a remarkable malleability and strength; pieces of them could be safely crumpled into one's hand and, when released, spring back into original shape. Additionally, there were small I-beams of great strength, and at least one larger fragment containing indecipherable symbols which could only be described as faintly resembling Egyptian hieroglyphics.² The Major understood that any US Military equipment would have been identified in English. Both men considered other possibilities such as a stray missile from the nearby White Sands Proving Grounds, home of America's fledgling rocket program; but if that were so why weren't they out looking for it?

At this point, Marcel wondered if he were witnessing a downed spacecraft that had crashed or exploded for reasons unknown.

On July 8, 1947 Roswell Base Commander Colonel William "Butch" Blanchard authorized the issuance of an official press release through Information Officer Walter Haut. The release stated that RAAB personnel had "captured" pieces of a disk presumed to be of extraterrestrial origin. The historic event was reported by every major newspaper in the Western United States and international phone calls were now flooding the Roswell area in view of the momentous announcement. Five hours after the original press release, Blanchard was given direct orders from The Pentagon that the initial release had been in error and that the wreckage represented, instead, the remains of a downed weather balloon.

Major Marcel was then ordered to fly immediately to Carswell Air Base, home of the Eighth Air Force Headquarters in Fort Worth Texas, and bring along some portion of the wreckage debris. In Fort Worth a hastily prepared press Conference demonstrated the "evidence" before a group of assembled press reporters and photographers. General Roger Ramey, speaking to the assemblage, explained Marcel's misidentification "error" while Marcel, who did not speak at all, was asked to

pose for pictures that additionally displayed weather balloon pieces, all distinctly dissimilar to the debris descriptions from the original press release only days earlier. The skeptical press gathering was not initially permitted to view the display at close proximity; after complaints and a brief delay, the press was brought closer to see what were in fact foil remnants of a very common weather balloon.³ Few visitors were sufficiently convinced that the Roswell matter had been satisfactorily explained.

The so called "Roswell Incident" remained the most controversial event of its kind for the next forty seven years. The now independent Air Force during said period never waived from its second "weather balloon" conclusion, steadfastly maintaining the revised explanation despite an advancing groundswell of skepticism to the contrary.

In May 1987 three UFO investigators produced an alleged "smoking gun" piece of evidence regarding the incident.⁴ Documents reportedly representing a supersecret "Majestic-12" organization appeared to be a November 1952 briefing paper for then President elect Eisenhower. The papers in part revealed the results of internal investigations regarding the crash; the strange writing discovered at the scene was not decipherable; the crashed vehicle had an undetermined power source; and bodies discovered a few miles east of the main crash site were biologically unlike human beings.⁵

This highly controversial information was the subject of heated debate concerning its authenticity; indeed the editors of Time Life Books indicated most observers felt the Document was "probably" a hoax. Debate has continued however; others thought the Document 100% accurate despite one of the three investigators having been since discredited; still others believed it to be a mix of facts and disinformation. Investigator Stanton Friedman had verified some thirty new facts from the Majestic-12 papers that had been unknown prior to the material's public release⁶; nevertheless the Air Force officially pronounced the Document "bogus".

In January 1994, New Mexico Congressman Steven Schiff, pressured by citizens and witnesses in his constituency, and having himself experienced a "stonewalling" effort in 1993 from the Air Force, initiated an official Congressional Investigation regarding the Roswell incident. Specifically, a search was begun in an attempt to locate any Government records relative to the matter. Congress' General Accounting Office enlisted the assistance of the Air Force in an attempt to locate documentation, from the Government or any agency thereof, that could "shed light" on the 1947 event.

While the investigation continued the "Roswell Declaration", a citizen's grassroots effort aimed at changing the laws to allow UFO documents further declassification, began in earnest. The Declaration itself surfaced through several independent organizations and was reprinted in a Summer 1994 issue of OMNI Magazine.

On September 8, 1994, without its investigative partner's foreknowledge, and forty seven years removed from its last official pronouncement, The Air Force announced that the Roswell crash was a hitherto classified "Project Mogul" spy balloon designed to measure air pressure waves from any Soviet atomic activity in the Pacific.⁷ The USAF further stated all existing Roswell records had been reviewed; as well, anyone previously tied to any "loyalty oath" regarding the matter had been released from it in order to assist with the investigation⁸. Said release had turned up three retired

officers all of whom supported the Mogul explanation. This report not only discredited Major Jesse Marcel, now deceased, as a witness but also criticized those UFO researchers who, in making alien body claims, were attempting to "make a living" off Roswell.⁹ The September 8th announcement, they continued, was the culmination of eight months of combined USAF-GAO efforts and that anyone with contrary evidence or information was invited to present it for further study. There was no indication as to why this new incident "answer" was not forthcoming for forty seven years.

A New York Daily News editorial, printed shortly after the USAF announcement, stated that the new explanation would "never put to rest" the still swirling rumors surrounding the incident.¹⁰

Just prior to the Mogul Report, Republic Pictures had released on the Showtime Cable TV Network a film entitled "Roswell; The UFO Coverup," starring Kyle MacLachlan as Jesse Marcel and country singer Dwight Yoakam as the rancher Brazel. The film purported to tell the Roswell story from eyewitness and witness' family accounts and was based on a former Military Intelligence Officer's book about the incident".¹¹ The movie alleged that the immense secrecy veil surrounding the incident was due to the extraterrestrial origin of the crash and the discovery, some two and a half miles east of the crash site, of three alien bodies and a fourth alien barely alive at the time.

In October 1994, on a live TV special on UFOs hosted by Larry King, retired Senator and former Presidential candidate Barry Goldwater recounted via videotape a disturbing exchange he'd had with Air Force General Curtis LeMay around 1965. Goldwater, fueled by Roswell rumors, had inquired about the incident and was sternly rebuffed by LeMay for having even brought it up. Goldwater, himself a Brigadier General in the Air Force Reserve at the time, was rather stunned at the bluntness of the response.

Shortly after, the respected veteran actress Sheila McRae (a former "Honeymooners" Alice) publicly discussed a confidential matter involving her late husband, show music legend Gordon McRae. Ms. McRae stated that in July 1947 her husband, then an Air Force Airman First Class assigned to Wright Air Base (now Wright-Patterson) in Ohio, personally witnessed four small bodies he described as "little men" being transported into the Base from an unknown origin. Airman McRae, deducing these victims were from the Roswell crash, was immediately sworn to secrecy by his superiors and, according to his spouse, carried the secret to his grave in 1986. The actress' comments were to have been made at the 1994 "Whole Life" Exposition in New York City but she apparently did not attend. New York Center For UFO Studies Director Michael Luckman informed me researcher Stanton Friedman had been thus far unable to verify that Gordon McRae did spend service time at Wright Air Base; Mr. Friedman soon after confirmed to me Mr. Luckman's comments. While Ms. McRae's statements were discussed on at least one television talk show and reprinted in a national tabloid newspaper,¹² at this writing the claims continue to be totally unsubstantiated.

The March 27, 1995 edition of the London England Daily Mail Newspaper carried a story about Ray Santilli, a British documentary filmmaker. He claimed he'd been sold reels of black and white film allegedly showing a Roswell crash victim's "Alien Autopsy" undertaken in Fort Worth Texas. These short reels, Santilli said, were made available to him for \$100,000.00 from an eighty two year old ex-military cameraman, unnamed, whom Santilli had been negotiating with for some early Elvis Presley films of the 1950's for future documentary use. Santilli stated he believed the film was genuine, though he admitted he knew nothing about the Roswell incident prior, and that his

discovery would would br initially previewed in public in the fall of 1995 at England.s Sheffield University during a UFO Research Conference.

President William J. Clinton issued an April 1995 Executive Order paving the way for large scale declassification of Government Documents rated Secret or below and more than twenty five years old, unless the possessing agency could show cause to continue classifying any specific documents in question. There were also nine "protected" categories of information which, under the law, would be exempt from disclosure. In all other cases, however, the practice of "when in doubt, declassify" would be used. As a general rule, UFO documents of a serious nature are classified Top Secret or higher, therefore it is believed the Government's policy change would not significantly affect high level UFO information.

SOME THOUGHTS AND OPINIONS ON THE ROSWELL INCIDENT

The majority of American citizens may be non-committal as to whether some UFOs could represent intelligently controlled craft of an unearthly origin; there also exists that segment of the population wanting to believe in their reality. Let us not discount of course the all out UFO skeptics such as the well-known Philip J. Klass, who says he can debunk any claimed sighting. He searches for what he calls "alternative explanations". At the opposite end is the gullible "fringe", all too ready to accept a tall story based solely on the hope it is factual.

In the middle of this morass is the legitimate UFO researcher and investigator who must contend with all manner of contemptible frauds and deceivers prepared to exploit interest in the subject for some combination of profit, glory or temporary fame. The researcher proceeds, fully expecting that the US Government and/or its agencies may provide disinformation (reference; the CIA's recent admittance they falsified reported UFO incidents, so they say, in order to mask sensitive spy plane flights.) Such false material by choice or chance throws legitimate investigations off track, sets up false leads for inevitable discrediting, and covers up vital information with a "national security" cloak even when the need is questionable.

Such stonewalling efforts have in the past trivialized UFO reports and caused honest investigations to slow to a trickle. Has such a policy gained its desired effect? For years the public perception is that UFOs are reported less often, and are taken less seriously than in the period 1947-1952, that of the great UFO "waves". In the 1990s everyone knows at least some person tainted with the old "little green men" mindset. Yet an ever increasing number of citizens no longer consider UFOs a laughable matter, often receiving welcome support from the scientific community. Three ex-astronauts, for example, have publicly stated that UFOs are a real and legitimate concern, with at least two of the three supporting the Roswell incident as a valid extraterrestrial event. The late NASA scientist Dr. Paul Hill's book "Unconventional Flying Objects: A Scientific Analysis" provides compelling support of his theory that some UFOs clearly obey, rather than act outside of, conventional laws of physics. We dare not forget retired NASA scientist Dr. Richard Haines whose compiled dossier of serious UFO encounters involving only *commercial pilots, jet pilots and one ex-astronaut* now numbers over three thousand.

I clearly am most sympathetic to the researcher/investigator, whose narrow windows of opportunity are hampered immensely in pursuit of the truth.

If the Roswell incident remains the watershed event in the annals of America's celebrated paranormal mysteries, then there are likely few researchers who at some time haven't looked into this remarkable story. Roswell enthusiasts each desire to possibly discover a new minute detail not hitherto addressed since its occurrence a half century ago.

What exactly happened at Roswell? I have been researching the matter for several years now, and while I respect the contrary viewpoints of others, I nonetheless find the answers literally jumping out at me, and often in a startling manner. Now that the USAF has admitted lying in their 1947 "downed weather balloon" explanation, and with the ongoing willingness of a number of people coming forward with formerly hidden information of relevance, and given the fact that Project

Mogul itself wasn't exactly a surprise, I have great difficulty accepting the notion of a balloon as the final answer to the Roswell story.

Consider the following points of contention that leave many of the official USAF pronouncements "suspect" or at minimum subject to far more questions than answers;

1. The Air Force's Fort Worth Press Conference, held specifically to debunk the initial "saucer" press release only days earlier, was so hastily conceived and poorly prepared that it's stunning to think a balloon would cause such an uproar. Test balloons of all types were quite prevalent in the Roswell area during this period; in fact, local citizens often benefited from a "standing order" of a \$50.00 reward if any military balloons they might find would be returned to the local Base. Therefore, the sight of one in someone's yard (or desert?) would have unnerved noone. Note also that one such citizen who'd seen those balloons not once but twice previously was the rancher Mac Brazel.

2. Mr. Brazel, following his report of the Corona desert wreckage, was involuntarily sequestered by the Air Force for several days or more, during which, according to accounts, he was heavily pressured to recant his "flying saucer" story. After his release he provided a different version to the public and apparently received a new \$3,000.00 truck for his efforts. Again, we must question the authenticity of any balloon story causing such a disruption.

3. The odd properties of some of the recovered materials at the crash scene - materials that withstood burning, drilling, hammering, denting, and which could be crumpled up in one's hand with no effect at all - are one facet of this mystery never satisfactorily answered by the Air Force, or anyone else accepting the military's explanation.

4. Colonel William Blanchard and Major Jesse Marcel, two Officers in the middle of the mystery, were later promoted to General and Lieutenant Colonel respectively, despite the negative backlash of their Roswell "mistake". (In fact, Blanchard was a Four Star General serving at the Pentagon as Vice Chief of Staff of the USAF at the time of his death in the mid 1960s). It is at least puzzling that their careers were apparently not affected by the events of early July 1947.

5. Glenn Dennis, a former mortician/embalmer for the Roswell area, now retired, has told of a strange phone call he received from an unnamed Base Army Captain in early July 1947. The caller requested information from Dennis about body preservation techniques, and the availability of some small hermetically sealed coffins. Just over an hour later Dennis drove his Funeral Home's ambulance into Roswell Air Base with an injured Airman. The mortician was admitted amidst a most abnormal flurry of activity, but was soon forcibly removed after being warned by a nurse acquaintance of his that he'd be in big trouble if he were to "find out". That evening, Dennis continued, he met his friend at the local Officer's Club, and the nurse, in an extremely nervous and excitable state, drew pictures of the "bodies" she'd seen at the Base in the course of her official rounds. This unnerving revelation made the mortician think back to the treatment given him at the Base Hospital only hours earlier. (Mr. Dennis was not actively sought by the USAF for input into the September 1994 Project Mogul Report.)

6. In a before-death statement in 1986 Norma Gardner, a former security-cleared secretary at Wright Air Base of Ohio in the late 1940s, told researcher Len Stringfield of her work logging in

any incoming materials of a UFO nature. She recalled that the items from Roswell, to include pathology reports, were in conformity with other witness accounts,¹³ adding that "Uncle Sam can't do anything to me once I'm in my grave"¹⁴ for having revealed this information.

During that same year former Army Staff Sergeant Melvin Brown, also nearing death, revealed to his children his involvement in the incident. His statements were that, at the time, any "available" Roswell Air Base men were taken to the crash site and ordered to "form a ring" around whatever they were protecting. The "cargo" was placed on trucks and the military participants were sworn to secrecy and told "not to look". Brown however said he was in the back of a truck transporting the cargo along with another Private; Brown lifted up the protective tarpaulin and witnessed what he described as three small dead bodies of "Asian" resemblance, yellowy color with large heads and no hair.¹⁵ They did not provoke his fear, though Brown was frightened only because he was disobeying orders in viewing the cargo.

Later, Brown was standing guard at the hangar where the cargo, packed in ice, was taken when his commanding officer came by and said he wanted to "have a look", inviting Brown to join him. These efforts produced nothing as the shipment had been placed in storage¹⁶ for eventual transport elsewhere.

Author Timothy Good has been provided evidence from Brown's kin that the enlisted man was stationed in the Roswell area at the time, and that a letter of recommendation written in 1948 for his promotion to Staff Sergeant indicated his duty with Task Force 7.4.1., calling attention to the "peculiar and tedious circumstances resulting from this project".¹⁷ Brown was also awarded numerous service medals for his exploits in World War II, attesting to his character. While the aforesaid information does not automatically verify Brown's story, his impressive background should at least allow fair consideration to his claims.

7. Brigadier General Arthur Exon told UFO investigators that in 1947 while he was a Lieutenant Colonel at Wright Air Base, and later a (commanding) Colonel there, Roswell materials were received and were tested immediately via a host of methods. The consensus of those who did the testing was that the pieces were from space¹⁸.

8. The circumstances surrounding the release of the 1994 Air Force Project Mogul Report claiming a Top Secret spy balloon was the Roswell answer seem coincidental, considering the civilian generated "Roswell Declaration" calling for UFO files declassification had just begun making news. Stanton Friedman, a former Top Secret nuclear physicist and longtime Roswell researcher, called the Air Force spy balloon conclusion "a pre-emptive strike," designed to head off the onrush of public anticipation toward a factual accounting of the incident¹⁹. Speaking on the Larry King "UFO Coverup Live" television show in October 1994, Friedman comments further; it should be no surprise, he says, that the New York Times/Washington Post papers, bastions of journalistic integrity, were chosen by the USAF as the vehicles to release the Mogul explanation. For the Air Force, Friedman continued, this fact was to have represented instant credibility, or so they figured. Yet the Times/Post never thought to question the credibility or authenticity of the Report, admittedly built on a lie already forty-seven years old. (All this, from the same people who brought you the Pentagon Papers and Woodward/Bernstein!).

So now, Friedman says, the Air Force starts with a downed saucer, then immediately changes it to.....well, no, it was a weather balloon, to.....well, no, it was a spy balloon! If we weren't supposed to have believed them for forty seven years, Stanton adds, why believe them now?

The 1994 Viacom Pictures film "Roswell, The UFO Coverup", released on cable-tv just weeks before the Mogul Report, was for me an emotional, wrenching "gut check" with regard to Roswell and UFOs, and even the Washington Post film review said it "offers up a nice, chilly case of the creeps". The story concerns retired Lieutenant Colonel Jesse Marcel, a first hand Roswell crash scene witness. Marcel in 1977 is thirty years older and still jaded over his treatment as the "fall guy" in the Roswell coverup efforts in 1947. Facing health problems, he sees one last opportunity to set the Roswell record straight, that being his reluctant acceptance of an invitation to attend the thirtieth anniversary reunion of his old 509th Bomb Group.

The film time-trips liberally, juxtaposing Marcel's flashbacks to the days of the incident with the startling information he learns three decades later from many of his peers. The movie leads the viewer to believe the new insights helped convince Marcel to "go public" on the matter, a decision he undertook in 1978 by way of a Stanton Friedman interview.¹⁰

The film's bittersweet ending is that "Jesse Marcel died in 1986. His story was ignored by the news media". The implication at the end, however, is that in his declining years Marcel fully knew the truth, knowledgeable of many others who apparently knew it along with him even if the others were able to "let it go" in a manner Marcel could not, right to his dying day.

Some have suggested that the presentation of definitive, irrefutable UFO proof, if made public, would change our very existence as we know it. We the public, they say, would experience profound alterations in our lifestyles, religions, global finances, allegiances, and general sensibilities. Nationalism and loyalty to leaders such as Presidents, Popes, etc. would suffer. These are in fact some of the generalized conclusions of a 1961 Brookings Institute Study commissioned by NASA. The Study's intent was to determine public reaction "if" an announcement were made that we are not alone. (I have been advised the study may still be ongoing).

Such conclusions are balanced by most major polls of the last few years. The results indicate greater public acceptance of the possibility of extraterrestrial existence and a perceived coverup of same. One such survey is a continuing poll conducted by the Scripps School of Journalism regarding attitudes toward Government. Over 1,000 people representing a wide variety of ages, socio-economic levels, races, etc. were recently asked as part of the survey The following; did they believe it was "somewhat or very likely" the Government knew more than it was revealing about UFOs, and was covering up such information? Fifty percent of this group responded yes to the question, with forty three percent indicating "not likely". With other polls showing similar pro-UFO leanings, it is clear the citizenry considers the UFO question at least worthy of interest and further study, rather than a notion to be discredited or ignored.

Should that announcement be forthcoming, I personally don't think I'd register surprise. I might be shocked, though, because in view of personal research and that of others, I'd be amazed our military finally came to grips with *how* to admit this secret to an American public already conditioned for half a century by a "denial and ridicule" policy concerning UFOs²¹.

UPDATE; A DISINFORMATION "TWIST"

In the course of researching information relevant to this paper, I came across on more than one occasion a "possibility" I confess I was not prepared for. This item seemed trivial at first but now appears far more significant than I'd imagined.

A number of researchers and sources maintain that the military's disinformation "effort" on UFOs even extends to the weekly tabloid newspapers, whose outrageous and often entertaining UFO stories provide everyone a good laugh or two. It is alleged that at least some of these intentional deceptions are purposely "leaked" in order to be set up for inevitable discrediting. The darker purpose of such yarns is to continually dull the public's senses about UFOs, drawing interest further away from serious encounters as opposed to those incidents drawn from imagination, deception, speculation or "dreamscape". It is also argued that some truthful information is part of the mix provided to the disreputable tabloids, with the effect of befuddling the public even more.

The ramifications of such claims, in a democratic society with its free press, may be as frightening to me as anything I've researched on the subject of Roswell or UFOs in general.

ASSESSING THE 1994 USAF PROJECT MOGUL REPORT; MORE UNANSWERED QUESTIONS

A curious but dispassionate reader who studies only the Project Mogul Report might very well conclude there never was anything anomalous to the Roswell mystery.; the "document" is that convincing. One could decide, after familiarization with the Report, that crash scene witness Jesse Marcel had committed a huge error in having misidentified the wreckage, leading to decades of speculation and claims concerning hidden bodies, intimidation of witnesses, a highly compartmentalized coverup, and more. After all, didn't the Air Force appear to go out of its way to cooperate with the General Accounting Office during the investigation to uncover appropriate Government records? Didn't the Air Force honestly interview three surviving witnesses (all retired military) who were direct participants in some part of the events? Weren't these people even permitted a "loyalty oath release" to assist in the investigation, in compliance with Congressman Schiff's access needs? Finally, after all this "evidence", didn't the civilian UFO investigators claiming an unearthly answer for Roswell seem shallow for having been unable to offer any contrary proof?

There is far more to the Mogul Report than meets the eye.

In April 1995, Stanton T. Friedman wrote me and indicated the three officers interviewed for the Report were released from their security oaths *only for the purpose of the investigation.....*how curious, therefore, that in each instance they echoed the "balloon" story, still secure with their retiree pensions intact.(The letter is reprinted in the Appendix Section of this paper). Additionally, Project Mogul was known to some UFO researchers well before the Air Force suddenly "found" documents to support its Roswell connection in 1994. The GAO, the supposed investigative partner in the investigation, was not swayed by the Air Force's pronouncement of Mogul being the "final official word"²¹ on Roswell and, at this writing, the GAO is continuing the investigation independently.

I should add that someone came to me in the early spring of 1995 to tell me they "knew a lot about Roswell". This person's claims were that in 1961 a high level engineer employed by a major defense contractor told the source of some "spider like" or "lizard like" bodies recovered from a UFO crash in 1947, according to associates of the engineer who'd seen them personally. I listened to these claims, wondering what would compel a person to volunteer this information anonymously without any consideration of notoriety or recompense if the story had no basis in fact. In this case, the person said they hadn't previously spoken to anyone on the matter for almost thirty five years.

My increasing curiosity about the Roswell incident was further piqued by some senior citizens who, having read this paper, remembered "that time" and said, to a man, none of them ever believed the Roswell crash involved a balloon.

I do not fault the Air Force for urging those with any evidence contradicting the Mogul conclusion to present it for further study. However since the Air Force would have long since confiscated any definitive proof not originally in their hands, exactly what is the civilian populace expected to provide?

Obviously, the recollections of those witnesses disputing the Mogul hypothesis carry little weight with the Air Force. One would conclude so because of the "short shrift" the opponents received by being practically excluded in the "comprehensive" Mogul Report of September 1994. If even *one* of the claims of such deceased persons as Jesse Marcel Sr., Norma Gardner, Gordon McRae, Melvin Brown and others is proven true, then should we pay less attention to similar claims among the living?

At this point, I'm concerned far less with the notion of extraterrestrial reality - really, could we be the *only* civilization out there? - than I am with what our Government and its affiliated agencies face in terms of credibility if we learn, incontrovertibly, that we are not alone. Should the truth turn out to be a startling revelation, one wonders of the consequences of an incredible story being buried, still with reasons unknown, for fifty years.

Robert J. VanDerClock

ADDENDUM

On May 10, 1995 I phoned Stanton Friedman at his Fredericton Canada location due to an overriding sense of curiosity about the supposed "Alien Autopsy" film; Stan had gone to England to preview the film reels and was apparently not permitted to do so. He believed from what he had learned that the film was not genuine, having challenged the film's new owner, Ray Santilli, to provide further information to substantiate the movie's alleged authenticity. Santilli has thus far not responded and in fact the British producer has been anything but cooperative on the matter, fueling fears of a widely publicized fraud.

With Friedman being the original civilian investigator of the Roswell incident, I'd automatically assume anyone in possession of such a film would welcome an expert analysis by him or someone qualified; regrettably that has not been the case thus far. The producer did state he'd paid \$100,000.00 for it, yet no record of purchase or receipt copy has been shown. The true identity of the supposed eighty two year old cameraman, listed as "JB" if indeed he exists, remains a mystery.

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THE ROSWELL DECLARATION

Forty-seven years ago, an incident occurred in the southwestern desert of the United States that could have significant implications for all mankind. It involved the recovery by the U.S. military of material alleged to be of extraterrestrial origin. The event was announced by the U.S. military on July 8, 1947, through a press release that was carried by newspapers throughout the country. It was subsequently denied by what is now believed to be a cover story claiming the material was nothing more than a weather balloon. It has remained veiled in government secrecy ever since.

The press release announcing the unusual event was issued by the commander of the 509th Bomb Group at Roswell Army Air Field, Colonel William Blanchard, who later went on to become a four-star general and vice chief of staff of the United States Air Force. That the weather balloon story was a cover-up has been confirmed by individuals directly involved, including the late General Thomas DuBose who took the telephone call from Washington, DC, ordering the cover-up. Numerous other credible military and civilian witnesses have testified that the original press re-

lease was correct and the Roswell wreckage was of extraterrestrial origin. One such individual was Major Jesse Marcel, the intelligence officer of the 509th Bomb Group and one of the first military officers at the scene.

On January 12, 1994, United States Congressman Steven Schiff of Albuquerque, New Mexico, announced to the press that he had been stonewalled by the Defense Department when requesting information regarding the 1947 Roswell event on behalf of constituents and witnesses. Indicating that he was seeking further investigation into the matter, Congressman Schiff called the Defense Department's lack of response "astounding" and concluded it was apparently "another government cover-up."

History has shown that unsubstantiated official assurances or denials by government are often meaningless. There is a logical and straightforward way to ensure that the truth about Roswell will emerge: an Executive Order declassifying any information regarding the existence of UFOs or extraterrestrial intelligence. Because this is a unique issue of universal concern, such an action would be appropriate and warranted. To provide positive assur-

ance for all potential witnesses, it would need to be clearly stated and written into law. Such a measure is essentially what presidential candidate Jimmy Carter promised and then failed to deliver to the American people 18 years ago in 1976.

If, as is officially claimed, no information on Roswell, UFOs, or extraterrestrial intelligence is being withheld, an Executive Order declassifying it would be a mere formality, as there would be nothing to disclose. The order would, however, have the positive effect of setting the record straight once and for all. Years of controversy and suspicion would be ended, both in the eyes of the United States' own citizens and in the eyes of the world.

If, on the other hand, the Roswell witnesses are telling the truth and information on extraterrestrial intelligence does exist, it is not something to which a privileged few in the United States government should have exclusive rights. It is knowledge of profound importance to which all people throughout the world should have an inalienable right. Its release would unquestionably be universally acknowledged as an historic act of honesty and goodwill.

I support the request, as outlined above, for an executive order declassifying any U.S. government information regarding the existence of UFOs or extraterrestrial intelligence. Whether such information exists or whether it does not, I feel that the people of the world have a right to know the truth about this issue and that it is time to put an end to the controversy surrounding it.

Signature

Date

Name (Please Print)

Street

Occupation/Title

City

State

Zip

Degrees/Credentials (if applicable)

U.S. Representative (if known)

APPENDIX B

STANTON T. FRIEDMAN
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CANADA

Mr. Robert J. Van Der Cloot (506) 457-0232

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April 16, 1995

Dear Bob:

I am way behind on my correspondence partly because of having to spend 5 days unexpectedly in England because of much publicity about some supposed Roswell 16mm film, so my apologies for not responding sooner to yours of April 6. Thanks for the kind words.

I will enclose my response to the USAF-NYT attack on Roswell. It is NOT true that the USAF has released everyone from their security oaths. Even the three retired guys they talked to were only released to talk to the investigators. I have been asking for a blanket release for years. The inconsistencies, false statements, etc are very much consistent with Colonel Weaver's background in disinformation. I will also enclose some other items. Your friend obviously knows nothing about the case.. but then the three basic rules for debunkers are: 1. What the public doesn't know, I won't tell them. 2. Don't bother me with the facts, my mind is made up. and 3. If one can't attack the data, attack the people.. it is easier.

The Post Office looms large in ufology these days.. Pat Marcatilio, who holds an annual conference in Bordentown, NJ, works for the PO. Barry Greenwood, document "researcher" in the Boston area, works for the PO. Lucius Farish, who has been doing the Clipping service for years and holds an annual conference in Arkansas, works for the PO; and, as it happens, Don Schmitt, Roswell "Professional investigator", who was claiming to be a medical illustrator and working on his doctorate, has two years of college and is a full time letter carrier for the PO.. much to everybody's surprise apparently including his co-author, Kevin Randle, who has written 78 books of fiction that he never mentions publicly...

Unfortunately, the debunkers aren't the only ones who ignore the truth...with friends like these, who needs enemies?

Hastily and most cordially,


Stan Friedman

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Special thanks go to my patient wife Helene who, with only a passing interest in the subject, knows I won't admit just how incredibly addictive this UFO business has become; my brother in law Rhea Cobb who shares a passion on these matters and urged me to "print it"; William VanSteveninck, a fellow 1964 graduate of Midland Park NJ High School who provided me, via Skeptical Inquirer magazine, with the eight page synopsis of the September 8, 1994 Air Force Mogul Report; and my sister Joy whose dogged persistence obtained for me significant information for this work.

NOTES AND REFERENCES

1. The more detailed description given later by Major Jesse Marcel, committed to film and the Friedman-Berliner book collaboration "Crash at Corona", was of a wreckage area 3/4 of a mile long and some 200 yards wide, greatly contrasting the initial Air Force "cover" of a small balloon crash site.
2. Several different accounts exist concerning these "symbols". One explanation is that they resembled "firecrackers" from a leftover Japanese balloon bomb launched prior to V-J Day or even possibly after it; another explanation is of flower-like symbols on tape from a Manhattan toy company as a wraparound for the kites, sticks, balsa wood, etc. of a classified balloon project. Marcel, having never seen anything like them, called them Hieroglyphic-like for lack of a better term.
3. One dubious theory discounting the "alien wreckage" hypothesis is that the "delay" was necessary in order to remove an "ML-307 Radar reflector" from the room; witnesses, as the story goes, might be unfamiliar with this equipment but would still notice the inclusion of something "additional", and determine the debris was more than an ordinary weather balloon.
4. The information, mysteriously arriving by mail in December 1984 at the home of TV producer and UFO researcher Jaime Shandera, and received in the form of an undeveloped 35mm roll of film, was subsequently analyzed and investigated by Shandera, William L. Moore and Stanton Friedman for about two and a half years before the public disclosure of its contents.
5. Timothy Good, Alien Liaison, The Ultimate Secret, pgs. 112-114.
6. Stanton T. Friedman, "Operation Majestic-12? Yes!", Appendix B-1.
7. "The Air Force Report on Roswell", no. 255-M, September 8, 1994, reprinted in "Skeptical Inquirer" Magazine, Jan./Feb., 1995 issue.
8. Ref., letter from Stanton Friedman to the author, reprinted in the Appendix section.
9. "The Air Force Report", op. cit., p.48.
10. The Editorial in question was, to my knowledge, one of the first to openly dispute the relevancy of a forty-seven year old "explanation" that could have been revealed many years ago.
11. "UFO Crash At Roswell", by Kevin D. Randle and Donald Schmidt, c.1991, Avon Books, NY NY 10019
12. "Star Magazine". December 6, 1994, p. 18
13. Time-Life Books, "Mysteries Of The Unknown, Alien Encounters", p.83.

14. Ibid.

15. Timothy Good, op. cit., p. 87.

16. Ibid..

17. Ibid., pgs. 87-88.

18. Time-Life Books, op. cit., p. 84.

19. Numerous researchers have attempted contact with Ms. McRae since her late 1994 comments concerning the matter. Stanton Friedman did interview her but he has been unable to corroborate any of the story. I myself attempted correspondence to a California address of hers on several occasions, only to have each letter returned to me "unclaimed".

20. Researcher Friedman deserves great credit for uncovering much of what civilization, outside the US Military, has learned about the Roswell incident. While preparing for a television interview on UFOs in 1978, Mr. Friedman was made aware of Houma, Louisiana resident Jesse Marcel ("who?"). The researcher was then told Marcel "handled one of those things" in 1947. "You can be sure *that* got my attention" was Stan's response to how the two-decade investigation of the Roswell incident began.

21. Timothy Good, "Above Top Secret. The Worldwide UFO Coverup", section titled "Critical Acclaim For 'Above Top Secret' " written by "Communion" author Whitley Strieber. In this section Strieber refers to "the stunning words of a former CIA Director who admitted (the existence of) the UFO coverup around a program of denial and ridicule." The individual is later identified as Admiral Stansfield Turner, Director Of Central Intelligence (DCI) under President Jimmy Carter in the late 1970s.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

ROBERT J. VANDERCLOCK graduated Midland Park NJ High School in 1964 and earned a B.A. Degree in June 1968 from Washington College of Chestertown, Maryland, the only American College founded by George Washington himself although others retain his name. VanDerClock is listed in the 1967-68 Edition of "Who's Who In American Colleges And Universities" publication.

As a graduating college Senior he was actively recruited for career work with the Central Intelligence Agency. He was ultimately rejected due to having simultaneously applied as a volunteer for The Peace Corps, an agency the CIA recruiter claimed was "financed" by the intelligence organization. (Note; The Peace Corps since 1981 has been considered an "independent" agency).

VanDerClock signed a professional baseball contract with the San Diego Padres organization on August 22, 1968 but soon after enlisted in the US Army. Following Basic Training, he was schooled as an Intelligence Agent, also receiving a year of Vietnamese language training prior to assignment with the 574th Military Intelligence Detachment, Can Tho, South Vietnam, during most all of 1971. He worked under civilian "cover" in behalf of the (Mekong) Delta Administrative Support Detachment, the cover name for Army Intelligence Operations in the Delta area.

His current mid-level Management position in the US Government is not connected in any way with the Space or Defense industry, the US Military or any civilian intelligence agency.

He has never seen a UFO. His sister Joy maintains she viewed a UFO "up close" during the summer of 1967 over the Prospect Street area of Midland Park NJ. (Robert, in New York State at the time, remembers the unnerving phone call made to him by his sister on the evening in question.) News accounts indicated the anomalous object traveled toward Haledon NJ's High Mountain where it proceeded to set part of the mountain's flat peak on fire. Joy, now living in Haledon, has since talked to two area firefighters who say they were part of the several units called to extinguish the blaze.

Robert's interest in UFOs began in junior high school. His curiosity took a quantum leap in 1988 after seeing a television special on the subject, "UFO Cover Up Live," hosted by Mike Farrell, famous as Doctor B. J. Hunnicut on television's "MASH".

Since early 1995, Robert has been in occasional contact with noted UFO researcher Stanton T. Friedman whose views, VanDerClock says, weigh significantly on his own.